- Classroom supplies
- Repairs and maintenance
- Field trip admissions
- General office supplies

Other expenses as deemed necessary and approved by the Director of Business Services or Controller.

P-Cards cards may not be used to circumvent the normal purchasing and/or requisitioning process.

The staff member to whom a credit card is issued shall be responsible for its use and shall not allow the card to be used by anyone else or for any unauthorized purchases. Any charges made on the card during the time that the card is in the possession of the employee are the responsibility of that employee. Unauthorized charges must be paid by the person to whom the card is assigned, and such unauthorized use shall subject the card holder to disciplinary action in accordance with law, District policy, and/or the terms of a negotiated agreement.

The person to whom a P-Card is issued is responsible for the protection and custody of the card. If a District card is lost or stolen, the person to whom the card was issued shall immediately notify the Director of Business Services or Controller. The P-Card holder and/or Controller will notify the issuing company to cancel the card if necessary.

The Business Office shall reconcile the credit card statements to the invoices relating to credit card transactions. Any charges appearing on statement that are missing invoices or other documentation will be investigated by the Business Office staff. The Business Office staff must notify the Director of Business Services or Controller and/or the credit card issuing company of any suspected fraudulent transactions appearing on the statement. Credit card balances must be paid within sixty (60) days of the initial statement date.

Travel and Related Expenses

This regulation provides guidelines for District employees and School Board members traveling at district expense to conferences, seminars, workshops and other appropriate, work-related meetings or events not involving the supervision of students.

Definitions – Travel and related expenses include the cost of transportation (by public carrier, private automobile, district-owned vehicles), meals, lodging and necessary incidental expenses incurred by district employees or board members while in attendance at or traveling to and from conferences, seminars and workshops or while engaged in other travel in accordance with district policy.

1. **Mileage Reimbursement** – District employees and School Board members traveling in their personal vehicle on District business may request reimbursement based on the Internal Revenue Service (IRS) standard mileage rate. The completed form must be printed and signed by the employee, authorized by the appropriate administrator and submitted to Accounts Payable. The district will reimburse mileage in accordance with IRS Publication 463.
    a. Travel is reimbursable from the employee's regular job location to the employee's temporary work location.
    b. Travel is *not* reimbursable from the employee's home to the employee's regular place of work, *even if* travel occurs multiple times daily or outside of regular work hours.
    c. Mileage reimbursement requests must be submitted within 60 days after the travel event for which reimbursement is sought. Except in extraordinary circumstances, reimbursement amounts for requests submitted after the 60-day period will be treated as taxable income, subject to income and employment taxes per IRS guidelines.

2. **Expense Reimbursement** – District employees and School Board members may request reimbursement for expenses incurred while in attendance at or traveling to and from conferences, seminars and workshops, or while engaged in other travel in accordance with district policy
    a. Expense reimbursements must be submitted on an Employee Check Request Form and include original, itemized receipts. Credit card statements do not serve as sufficient documentation for

reimbursement purposes as they do not provide the itemized details required for an effective review.

b. Reimbursement requests for expenses must be submitted within 60 days after the expenses were paid or incurred. Except in extraordinary circumstances, reimbursement amounts for expenses submitted after the 60-day period will be treated as taxable income, subject to income and employment taxes per IRS guidelines.

3. **Regional and Out-of-State Travel -** Regional and state travel may be permitted, with supervisor approval, for district employees and School Board members under the following conditions:
   a. The purpose of the travel fits with district and/or school goals and/or curriculum;
   b. There is a sufficient balance in the appropriate budget to cover the expenses to be incurred;
   c. Consideration is given to the number of employees from that particular school and/or department and/or the district planning to attend the same event;
   d. If the travel involves at least one overnight stay outside the district, the travel request is submitted in writing to the employee's supervisor

The administrator approving attendance and travel is responsible for determining the reasonableness and necessity of the expense claimed within district policy and has the authority to disallow unreasonable or unnecessary expenses.

4. Airline Travel

a. Airline tickets should be booked online or by the least expensive method, preferably using a district procurement card (PCard). The district provides for travel on coach class or tourist class only.

b. In accordance with state law, frequent flyer miles and other airline travel credit resulting from district-paid airfare will accrue to the district and may not be used for personal travel. If the airline will not honor a transfer or assignment of any credit or benefit, the employee must report receipt of the credit or benefit to the district within 90 days of receiving it.

5. Accommodations

a. Individuals are expected to select accommodations, when they have an option, at the most reasonable rate. Lodging shall be selected on the basis of reasonable cost in conjunction with comfort, safety and convenience.

b. When an individual is traveling with a non-employee, the district will reimburse expenses for the employee only.

c. The district will reimburse expenses for overnight accommodations in the seven- county Twin Cities metropolitan area only if the employee or School Board member is working at the conference.

d. Original, itemized receipts are required for all accommodation claims.

6. Meals Reimbursement

a. The district will not use funds sourced from federal grants or awards for meal reimbursements.

b. Reimbursement will be based upon actual expenditures; individuals must provide original, itemized receipts for meal expenditures.

c. The maximum reimbursement for meals per person, including the tax and tip, is as follows: $60 per day, or for partial days $12 for breakfast, $18 for lunch and

d. $30 for dinner.

e. The district will not reimburse the cost of alcoholic beverages.

f. The district will reimburse the cost of banquets or special functions related to an individual's responsibility or participated in by the general audience attending a particular conference, workshop or seminar. It is necessary to document these additional expenses.

7. Other Costs

a. The district will reimburse registration fees relating to conference, workshop or seminar attendance.

b. The district will not reimburse for entertainment or recreation costs that are either part of or separate from the conference, workshop or seminar.

c. Printed and audio publications which contain the proceedings or are supplementary to attendance at a given conference, workshop or seminar, and which are relevant to the employee's or board member's attendance at the conference, may be purchased with the approval of the appropriate

supervisor.

d. The district will reimburse a reasonable cost of baggage handling when necessary.
e. Individuals are expected to select transportation at the conference, workshop or seminar, when they have an option, at the most reasonable rate. Transportation shall be selected on the basis of that which is as reasonable in cost as consistent with comfort, safety and convenience. Individuals are expected to use conference transportation (i.e., shuttle buses) whenever it is available.
f. Reimbursement for the use of rental cars by employees and board members is allowed only with prior approval by the superintendent or designee or, in the case of board members, by the board chairperson.
g. The district will not reimburse telephone calls for personal or family purposes. When reimbursement is requested for district-related calls, the party called must be noted on the receipt.
h. Exceptions to allowed travel expenses must be approved by the superintendent or designee for employees and by the board chairperson for board members.

8. **Travel and Related Expenses Involving Multiple District Staff** – When travel involves more than one district employee, each employee must separately account for their own individual expenses.
    a. Employee Check Requests – Employee Check Requests should not contain expenses for more than one employee. If reimbursement will be sought through this procedure, each employee must separately pay for their own individual expenses and submit their own Employee Check Request documenting such expenses.
    b. PCards – PCards may be used only for the individual cardholder's expenses and may not be used to pay for co-worker expenses (such as airline tickets, meals, etc.)

Training and Sanctions

The District will provide training to all staff involved in these procedures through activities such as:

- Orientation of new staff
- Distribution of federal laws, regulations and guidance
- Distribution of District procedures
- Developing templates, checklists and other guidance documents as appropriate
- Internal training sessions
- Routine staff meetings
- Informal technical assistance.

The Business Office staff will meet with District staff as necessary to ensure that these procedures are followed. These meetings may occur either on an individual basis or in a group setting.

Board Policies:

- There are no existing Board policies over training and sanctions.

See other grant procedures as these procedures do not constitute the full procedures of the District.

Employee Accountability and Sanctions:

Failure to follow the provisions of the appropriate procedures will subject the individuals responsible for the violation(s) to administrative and/or disciplinary actions in accordance with District disciplinary procedures and the judgment of management.